

SAFE | SAFE-14

Feature Definition

A service that fulfils a stakeholder need, sized to fit within one planning interval

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	Feature Definition
Document reference	SAFE-14-HEL-T2-v1.0
Project / Programme	Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build
Version	1.0
Status	Baselined
Date	18 Sep 2026
Author	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Owner	Product Management
Approver	Product Management, with Business Owner input on value
Classification	Internal
Retention	7 years from programme closure

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	04 Jun 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Initial draft
0.2	21 Jul 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Updated following workstream lead review
1.0	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Chief Platform Architect	Technical content and solution alignment	08 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Security, assurance and residency content	10 Sep 2026
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Finance Business Partner	Cost, funding and benefit figures	11 Sep 2026
M. Verity, Head of P3O	Head of P3O	Governance standards and completeness	15 Sep 2026

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO	Approved	18 Sep 2026
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	Director of Infrastructure	Approved	18 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Approved subject to closure of ISS-003	18 Sep 2026

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
SAFE-04	Epic Hypothesis Statement	Features may derive from epics
SAFE-16	PI Objectives	Features roll up into objectives
SAFE-18	Team Backlog and User Story	Features decompose into stories
P2-12	Product Description	Predictive equivalent

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Defines an item in the ART backlog — what it does, the benefit hypothesis behind it, its acceptance criteria and its WSJF score. The primary unit of planning at PI planning.
Framework	SAFe — Agile Product Delivery — ART Backlog and Features
Created when	During backlog refinement, before PI planning
Reviewed / updated	At each refinement session and at PI planning
Owner	Product Management
Approver	Product Management, with Business Owner input on value
Format options	Document, presentation, register entry, or tool record — the content matters, not the medium.
Tailoring	Most teams manage features in the ALM tool. Use this template as the field definition for that tool and for features significant enough to warrant a written record.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- It fits in a single PI for a single ART — if not, it is a capability or an epic
- The benefit hypothesis states an expected outcome, not an output
- Acceptance criteria are testable and include non-functional criteria
- WSJF is scored relative to other features, not in isolation
- Enablers required to build it are identified

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1. Feature identity

Field	Detail
Feature ID	SAFE-14-HEL-T2-v1.0
Title	Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build
ART	Helios AI Platform ART
Parent epic / capability	Liquid-cooled high-density compute at 60 kW per rack
Feature type	Business / Enabler
Owner	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Target PI	92% at 256-GPU job scale
State	Funnel / Analysing / Backlog / Implementing / Done

2. Description

A short phrase and a benefit statement. Written so a Business Owner can score its value without a briefing.

In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.

3. Benefit hypothesis

What outcome we expect, for whom, and how we will know. If you cannot state a measure, ask whether the feature is worth building.

Field	Detail
Expected outcome	Delivered and accepted at the PI 4 system demo
Beneficiary	Excluded from Tranche 2 and deferred to the AUH-2 second site
Measure	GPU utilisation, rolling 30-day average
Baseline	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate on 18 Sep 2026, v1.0
Target	Zero open critical findings
Measured when	15 Oct 2026

4. Acceptance criteria

Include functional and non-functional. For anything touching security, the security acceptance criterion belongs here, not in a separate review at the end.

Ref	Criterion	Type	Verification
AC-1	Independent penetration test closed with no open critical or high findings	Functional	Independent penetration test closed with no open critical or high findings
AC-2	No unsigned container image can be admitted; every attempt is alerted within 30 seconds	Non-functional	All-reduce efficiency at or above 92% on three consecutive 256-GPU runs

5. WSJF scoring

User / business value	Time criticality	Risk reduction / opportunity	Cost of delay	Job size	WSJF	Ranked
AI Research	4 weeks	Improves PUE from 1.62 to 1.21 across the estate	AED 11,200,000	Handled through the Agile Release Train rather than the predictive workstreams	Scoped to the three onboarding tenants: AI Research, Fraud Analytics and Retail	Applies from hall A handover; hall B follows in Tranche 2 closure

6. Enablers and dependencies

Ref	Type	Description	Owner	Needed by
Reflected in the solution intent as a fixed constraint	Enabler / Dependency	Signed container image supply chain	K. Adeyemi, Security Architect	Applies only to workloads classified Restricted or above
EAD-02	Architectural	Firmware attestation at node admission	K. Adeyemi, Security Architect	Agreed with the integration partner at design freeze, 15 Oct 2026
EAD-03	Architectural	Workload identity federation	K. Adeyemi, Security Architect	Applies from hall A handover; hall B follows in Tranche 2 closure
EAD-04	Infrastructure	Observability ingest capacity uplift	G. Lindqvist, Service Operations	Funded from the Tranche 2 allocation of AED

Ref	Type	Description	Owner	Needed by
			Lead	118,000,000
EAD-05	Exploration	Checkpoint-and-resume for distributed jobs	P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead	Escalated to the Portfolio Board where it exceeds programme tolerance
EAD-06	Architectural	Cross-hall control plane for failover	T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Applies across DXB-1 halls A and B for the Tranche 2 scale build

7. Stories

Populated during team breakouts at PI planning. Left blank at refinement.

Story ID	Story	Team	Points	Iteration
ST-4101	As a platform administrator, I want to define a fair-share quota per tenant, so that no tenant can starve another during contention	Scheduler team	5	Iteration 1
ST-4102	As a researcher, I want my job to queue with a visible position and estimated start, so that I can plan my work	Scheduler team	3	Iteration 2
ST-4103	Deploy the quota controller to the staging cluster with policy loaded from Git	Scheduler team	3	Iteration 1
ST-4104	Determine whether checkpoint-and-resume can be achieved without framework changes — output: a written recommendation	Scheduler team	2	Iteration 1
ST-4105	As a security engineer, I want unsigned images refused at admission, so that only verified software runs on the estate	Supply chain team	5	Iteration 2
ST-4106	As a finance business partner, I want a monthly consumption export per tenant, so that I can raise internal recharges	Platform services team	3	Iteration 3

8. Acceptance record

Date	Accepted by	Notes
15 Oct 2026	V. Chandra, Product Management	Complete — evidence in the ART launch pack
30 Nov 2026	M. Verity, Head of P3O	In progress — on track for the launch date